

Vishrut Malhotra

Ph.D. Candidate, Ashoka University, Sonipat, Haryana, India

Website | vishrut.malhotra_phd20@ashoka.edu.in

Education

Ashoka University, Sonipat, Haryana, India

2020 — Summer 2026

Ph.D. Candidate, Department of Economics

(Expected)

Ashoka University, Sonipat, Haryana, India

2017 — 2019

M.A. (Hons.) Economics

University Honours: Cum Laude

University of Delhi, Delhi, India

2013 — 2016

B.A. (Hons.) Economics

Research Interests

Firm Dynamics and Upgrading, International Trade, Industrial Organisation, and Innovation

Research Work

Working Papers

Product Quality Upgrading in response to Chinese Competition (Job Market Paper)

Abstract: This paper examines how increased product market competition from China affects product quality upgrading in Indian manufacturing. Using plant-level production data from India, I infer product quality from price and quantity information following the approach of Khandelwal et al. (2013). For identification, I instrument Chinese imports into India with growth in Chinese exports to the rest of the world at the product-year level, isolating supply-driven variation in Chinese competition. I find that a 10 percent increase in Chinese competition raises the quality of products produced by Indian plants by around 1 percent, but this response is highly heterogeneous and concentrated entirely among large plants. These plants upgrade by increasing investment in fixed capital and the share of intermediate input costs, consistent with capital deepening and input upgrading as key mechanisms. Smaller plants exhibit no significant response. I further document parallel evidence of quality upgrading in Indian exports at the product-export-market level using trade data. Export-market quality upgrading is concentrated in products sold to relatively high-income markets.

Product Expansion in Indian Manufacturing

Abstract: This paper examines the role of revenue concentration as a predictor of product addition in multi-product Indian manufacturing firms. Empirical analysis indicates that firms with more concentrated revenue streams are less likely to diversify their product portfolios, holding the number of products constant. To understand this relationship, I develop a dynamic model of heterogeneous firms, where multi-product firms produce differentiated varieties in a general equilibrium setting. The model integrates the dynamic industry framework of Hopenhayn (1992) with the flexible manufacturing environment of Mayer et al. (2014), incorporating two-dimensional firm heterogeneity: core marginal costs and product customisation costs. While core marginal costs evolve over time following an AR(1) process, customisation costs are fixed upon realisation. The model successfully replicates the empirical relationship, demonstrating that firms with higher revenue concentration, despite having higher core productivity, are less likely to diversify due to elevated customisation costs. In contrast, firms with lower revenue concentration exhibit lower core productivity and customisation costs, enabling them to pursue diversification by adding new products as a primary growth strategy. These findings provide insights into the interplay between firm-level cost structures and expansion strategies of multi-product manufacturing firms in India.

Work in Progress

Trade shock and Product Complexity

Policy

[IGC India Evidence Paper: Firms, trade, and productivity](#)

(with Shruti Bhimsaria and Tim Dobermann)

Conference Talks

Conversation on Research (CoRe), PhD. Colloquium, IGIDR, Mumbai, India 2024

Winter School, Delhi School of Economics, Delhi, India 2024

Teaching Experience

Teaching Fellow, Ashoka University

Graduate level courses

Macroeconomics (Instructor: Dr. Anuradha Saha) Monsoon 2023

Macroeconomics (Instructor: Dr. Pubali Chakraborty) Monsoon 2022

Undergraduate level courses

Introduction to Finance (Instructor: Dr. S.K. Shanthi) Spring 2024

International Finance (Instructor: Dr. Biswajit Banerjee) Spring 2022, 2023

Monetary Theory (Instructor: Dr. Arghya Bhattacharya) Monsoon 2021

Fellowships

Ashoka University

Axis-Ashoka Senior Research Fellowship 2022 — Present

Junior Research Fellowship 2020 — 2022

Work Experience

Centre For Advanced Financial Research And Learning (CAFRAL) 2019 — 2020

Reserve Bank of India, Mumbai, India

Research Associate

Genpact, Enterprise Risk Consulting 2016 — 2017

Gurugram, India

Analyst

Skills

Software and Programming

Stata, Python, Matlab, L^AT_EX

Languages

English (Fluent), Hindi (Native)

References

Anuradha Saha

Assistant Dean, Academic Affairs
Associate Professor
Department of Economics
Ashoka University
Sonipat, Haryana - 131029, India
Email: anuradha.saha@ashoka.edu.in

Lalit Contractor

Assistant Professor
Department of Economics
Ashoka University
Sonipat, Haryana-131029, India
Email: lalit.contractor@ashoka.edu.in

Abhishek Rai

Assistant Professor
Department of Economics
Ashoka University
Sonipat, Haryana-131029, India
Email: abhishek.rai@ashoka.edu.in